



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

It was a pure fluke!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Ask your partner:

- What is something you have done completely by accident?
- What happened as a result?
- How is your life different now?

Can Do Statements

- I can express beliefs, opinions, and annoyance.
- I can report details, reasons, or results of events or actions.
- I can talk about past habits.

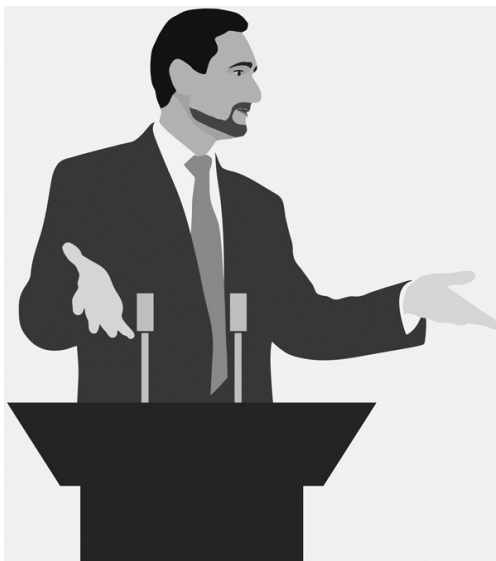




Let's Explore!

Welcome to Toastmasters! I will be your master of ceremonies and will guide you through an evening of fun, facts and **frivolity***.

* "Frivolity" is a lack of seriousness; light-heartedness.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Ladies and gentlemen! Fellow toastmasters! It is my pleasure to call this meeting to order. Welcome one and all! My name is Howard Taylor and it is my pleasure to act as master of ceremonies tonight. Here at Toastmasters, we support breezy introductions, so if you don't mind, I'm going to tell you a little story about how I started in this club.

I was once a very shy man, if you can believe it. I understand why this seems hard to believe. At social events, I was always waiting in the corner, hoping no one would come my way. My wife was always asking to go out, but I only wanted to stay at home. I was always trying to avoid jobs that required dealing with the public.

The truth of the matter is that joining Toastmasters was an accident of history. It was a pure fluke. My sister-in-law, who later joined the club -- I wonder where she is -- ah, there. Please stand for applause, Gertrude.

I know you are all wondering where this story is going. As I was saying, my sister-in-law's toaster broke down, and I was doing an Internet search for a new one, when I came across the website of our own Toastmaster's Club! I wondered how the idea of practicing my public speaking techniques could help draw me out of my shyness. I had my doubts at first. I feel we all have our doubts about our ability to change our ways of the past. I said to myself: I'm fed up with being shy! For Pete's sake! I can't bear it any longer! So I took the plunge, and I have never looked back since.





Let's Practice!

Howard expresses his thoughts.

Instructions: Match the beginning of the sentences in Column A to the end of the sentences in Column B. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. I understand why
2. I wonder
3. I know you are all wondering where
4. I wondered how
5. I wonder what

COLUMN B

- a. the idea of practicing my public speaking techniques could help draw me out of my shyness.
- b. where she is.
- c. happened to her.
- d. this seems hard to believe.
- e. this story is going.



Let's Practice!

Howard talks about past habits that annoyed him.

Instructions: Choose the option that best completes the sentence.

- 1) At social events, I was always _____ in the corner, hoping no one would come my way.
 - a) waited
 - b) waiting
 - c) wasting
- 2) My wife _____ to go out, but I only wanted to stay at home.
 - a) was asking always
 - b) was always asked
 - c) was always asking
- 3) I _____ to avoid jobs that required dealing with the public.
 - a) did always trying
 - b) was always tried
 - c) was always trying
- 4) I was continuously _____ myself about why all the people I gathered with were so shallow.
 - a) to question
 - b) questioning
 - c) questioned
- 5) People's behaviors were constantly _____.
 - a) to annoy
 - b) annoyed
 - c) annoying





Extension Activity

Do a survey about things people have done by accident.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Look for inventions that were developed by accident.
- Choose the invention you find the most interesting.
- Explain how it was invented by using a graphic organizer.
- Explain the graphic organizer to the class.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I look for inventions that were invented by accident.

☐ ☐

I summarize information in a graphic organizer.

☐ ☐

I share my findings with a group.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **breezy** (adjective): wordy; lots of talking
e.g. Here at Toastmasters, we support breezy introductions.
- **master of ceremonies** (noun): the person who runs a formal event
e.g. My name is Howard Taylor and it is my pleasure to act as master of ceremonies tonight.
- **ways of the past** (expression): the things a person used to do
e.g. We all have our doubts about our ability to change our ways of the past.
- **pure fluke** (noun): a great accident; without any planning
e.g. Joining the Toastmasters was a pure fluke.
- **accident of history** (expression): something that was not supposed to happen
e.g. The truth of the matter is that joining Toastmasters was an accident of history.
- **toaster** (noun): a small electrical device used to heat bread (or other foods) until it turns brown
e.g. My sister-in-law's toaster broke down, and I was doing an Internet search for a new one.
- **never look back** (expression): keeping going in the same direction without having any regrets
e.g. So I took the plunge, and I have never looked back since.
- **for Pete's sake** (expression): this is crazy
e.g. I said to myself: I'm fed up with being shy! For Pete's sake!
- **I can't bear it any longer** (expression): this is unbearable; things have to change
e.g. I said to myself: I can't bear it any longer!





Learning Points

The Wh-Clause as Object

You can make wh-clauses after certain verbs with wh-words like *who*, *whom*, *whose*, *what*, *when*, *where*, *why*, *that* and *how*.

You can use some verbs without an object.

- *I searched online and found out **why** the sky is blue.*
- *I wonder **what** happened to Maria since she never called me back.*

However, there are some verbs for which you need to follow the wh-clause with an object.

remind
inform
teach
warn
tell
advice

You can also use these verbs with the infinitive after the wh-clause.

- *The doctor advised his patient **how** to take care of his broken leg.*
- *The president reminded citizens **when** to stay indoors during the curfew.*

You can usually use **ask** and **show** followed by an object before the wh-clause, but not always.

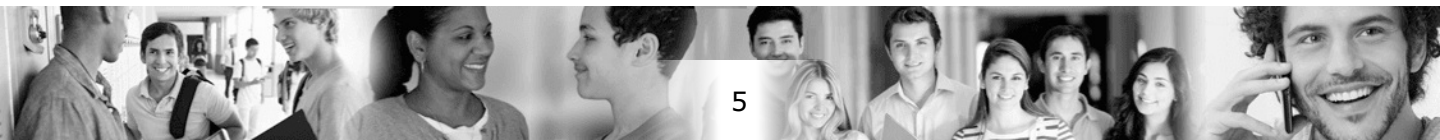
- *Marcos asked his mother **how** to bake a cake.*
- *Marcos asked (his mother) **how** he could bake a cake.*

If you want to talk about how to do something or get somewhere, the means by which you do these things, you can use **the way** instead of **how**.

- *I know **how** to make money easily. ↔ I know **the way** to make money easily.*
- *Could you tell me **how** to exit the parking lot? ↔ Could you tell me **the way** to exit the parking lot?*

Examples:

- *I understand why this seems hard to believe.*
- *I wonder where she is.*





Learning Points

Past Continuous for Frequent Habitual Action

You can use the past continuous verb tense to talk about actions that frequently happened in the past. It can also be used to express annoyance with repeated actions in the past.

You use the past continuous tense (*be + verb-ing*) to talk about actions that were in progress at a particular moment or time in the past.

Example:

- I **was talking** with my mother when the phone rang. (*longer action happening that was interrupted*)
- I **was studying** while my roommate **was taking** a shower. (*simultaneous actions*)

If you want to show that a repeated action in the past annoyed or irritated you, you need to use the past continuous with "**always**" or "**constantly**".

Example:

- Jose **was always talking** in class. I could never hear what the teacher was saying.
- My roommate **was always losing** her keys. I hated it when she would have to borrow my keys or call me to come home and open the door.

In speaking, you can place more stress on **always** or **constantly** to better show this annoyance.

☆☆☆ Using the past continuous in this way does not mean that the actions always happened in the literal sense. It insinuates that they happened very frequently; it was enough to annoy you.

If you want to say that the actions happened every single time, then you use the *past simple*.

Jose always talked in class. (Jose talked in every class.)

Examples:

- At social events, I was always waiting in the corner, hoping no one would come my way.
- I was always trying to avoid jobs that required dealing with the public.

